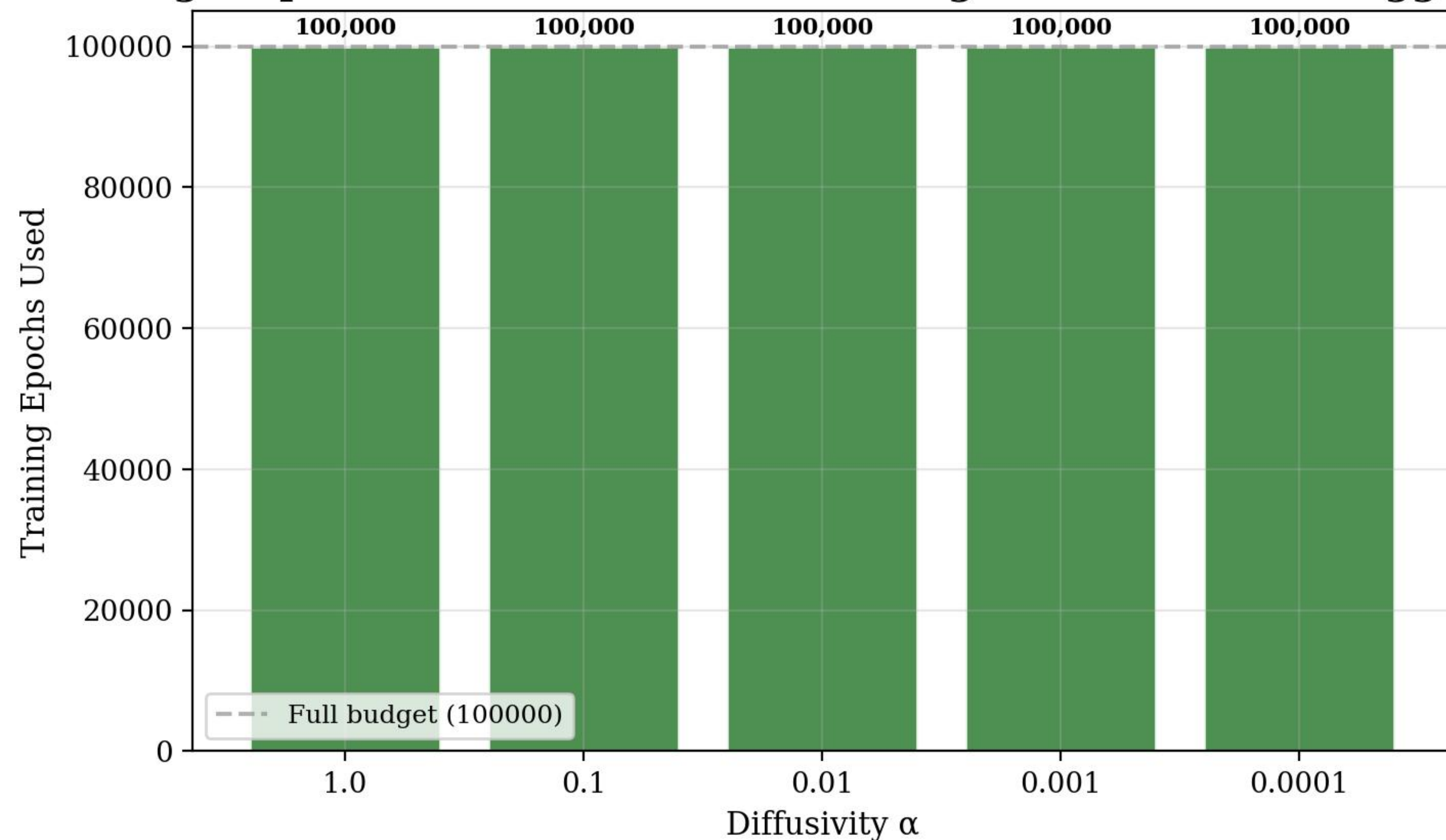


Key Finding: Premature Early Stopping at High Stiffness (Small α)

The optimizer plateau is caused by LR-schedule flattening AND gradient magnitude shrinkage at small α .

Premature Early Stopping vs Diffusivity

Orange = plateau detected before full budget. Green = full budget



Final Loss vs Diffusivity

High final loss despite 'convergence' = premature stagnation, not true convergence.

